ROCKWELL SOFTWARE

# RSLadder™

ActiveX™ Control

## Getting Results Guide

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Allen-Bradley
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ROCKWELL SOFTWARE
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*Chapter*

# 1 Installing & activating RSLadder

## About RSLadder

RSLadder ™ ActiveX™ controls display ladder logic for the Allen-Bradley SLC 500™ and PLC-5™ families of processors. View, search, and diagnose ladder logic, both offline and online, inside RSView32™, or inside other containers such as Microsoft® Visual Basic® or Microsoft Internet Explorer.

## System requirements

RSLadder requires RSView32 or another development environment capable of hosting ActiveX controls. RSLadder requires an Intel® Pentium® processor, at least 16 MB of RAM, and at least 30 MB of free hard disk space.

**Recommended hardware**. When running RSLadder inside RSView32, use the system requirements recommended for RSView32: Personal computer with 200 MHz Intel Pentium processor and 64 MB of RAM. Individual applications may require a faster processor or more RAM. For detailed recommendations, check the Rockwell Software Support Library, http://support.software.rockwell.com/supportlibrary/; refer to tech note A1191.

**Required operating system**. Microsoft® Windows NT® Workstation, version 4.0 with Service Pack 4 or 6a, Windows 2000 Professional or Windows 2000 Server, or Windows 95/98.

# Installing software components

The software components that you need to install depend on the container in which you plan to use the RSLadder ActiveX controls. For example, you might want to use RSLadder with:

- RSView32
- RSView32 Active Display System
- Another application that supports ActiveX controls, such as Microsoft Visual Basic

## Installing RSLadder with RSView32

To use RSLadder with RSView32:

- **Install and activate RSView32 6.30** or later, either Works or Runtime, and then restart your computer before installing RSLadder. For installation and activation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSView32 software.
- **Install RSLadder 4.0** or later. Both RSLadder 500 and RSLadder 5 are included on the RSView32 Extensions CD-ROM for no additional charge. As a result, it is not necessary to purchase licenses or to activate the RSLadder software when used with RSView32. See RSLadder installation steps on page 6.
- **Install RSLinx™** to provide communications between RSLadder 5 and a PLC-5 or between RSLadder 500 and an SLC 500. For system requirements, and installation and activation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSLinx software. With RSView32, you must use RSLinx, RSLinx OEM, RSLinx Professional, or RSLinx Gateway. RSView32 does not run with any RSLinx package in Lite mode.

## Installing RSLadder with RSView32 Active Display System

RSView32 Active Display System™ is a client/server option that provides remote access to your RSView32 projects. To use RSLadder with RSView32 Active Display system, install RSLadder and RSLinx software components on the server and on each client.

### On the Active Display Server

- **Install and activate RSView32 6.30** or later, either Works or Runtime, and then restart your computer. For installation and activation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSView32 software.
- **Install and activate RSView32 Active Display Server 6.30** or later. For installation and activation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSView32 Active Display System software.
- **Install RSLadder 4.0** or later. Both RSLadder 500 and RSLadder 5 are included on the RSView32 Extensions CD-ROM for no additional charge. As a result, it is not necessary to purchase licenses or to activate the RSLadder software when used with RSView32. See RSLadder installation steps on page 6.
- **Install and activate RSLinx Gateway**. This allows RSLinx Lite on Active Display clients to communicate with processors on the Allen-Bradley network. For installation and activation instructions and system requirements, refer to the documentation provided with the RSLinx Gateway software.
- **Configure RSLinx Gateway**. From the RSLinx Gateway menu, select Communication > Configure Gateway. Select Enable RSLinx Gateway. Shut down and restart RSLinx Gateway.

### On each Active Display client

- **Install and activate RSView32 Active Display Station 6.30** or later. For installation and activation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSView32 Active Display System software.
- **Install RSLadder 4.0** or later. Both RSLadder 5 and RSLadder 500 are included on the RSView32 Extensions CD-ROM for no additional charge. As a result, it is not necessary to purchase licenses or to activate the RSLadder software when used with RSView32. See RSLadder installation steps on page 6.
- **Install RSLinx Lite** to provide communications from RSLadder (installed on Active Display clients) to RSLinx Gateway (installed on the Active Display Server). RSLinx Lite is included for no additional charge on the RSView32 Extensions CD-ROM and does not require activation. For installation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSLinx Lite software.
- **Configure Internet Explorer** to update the RSLadder displays. See Configure Internet Explorer below.

### Configure Internet Explorer

The steps below apply to Microsoft Internet Explorer versions 4.0 and 5.0.

1. From the Windows Start menu, point to Start > Settings > Control Panel.
2. Double-click the Internet icon to open its properties.
3. On the General tab, click the Settings button.
4. Select the option: Every Visit to the Page. Click OK.
5. Click OK to close the Internet Properties window.

## Installing RSLadder with third-party software

To use RSLadder with third-party software such as Microsoft Visual Basic:

- **Install the third-party application**; refer to the documentation provided with the software.
- **Install and activate RSLadder 4.0** or later. When using RSLadder inside a container other than RSView32 or RSView32 Active Display System, you must purchase licenses from Rockwell Software. See RSLadder installation steps on page 6.
- **Install RSLinx** to provide communications between RSLadder and the SLC 500 or PLC-5 processors. For installation and activation instructions, refer to the documentation provided with the RSLinx software.

**TIP** Rockwell Software uses activation to provide copy protection for its software products. For information about activation, refer to the activation utilities online help file, COPYPROT.HLP. From the Start menu, select Programs > Rockwell Software > Utilities > Activation Help.

## RSLadder installation steps

The steps below explain how to install RSLadder from CD-ROM to a computer where software that supports ActiveX controls, such as RSView32 Works or RSView32 Runtime, is installed. Install RSLadder 500 (for use with Allen-Bradley SLC 500 processors) and RSLadder 5 (for use with Allen-Bradley PLC-5 processors) separately.

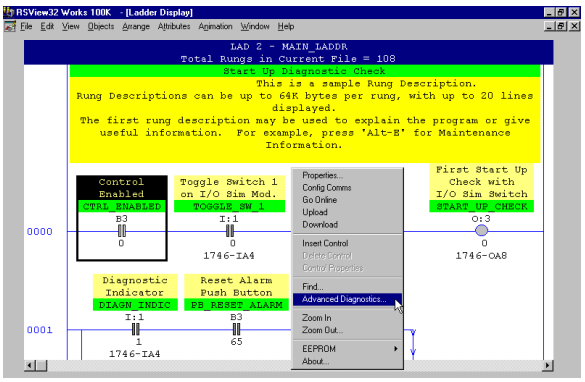
1. Close all open Windows programs.
2. Place the CD-ROM containing the RSLadder software in your CD-ROM drive.
   - If you are installing RSLadder from the RSView32 Extensions CD-ROM, run D:\START.EXE where D is the drive containing the CD-ROM.
   - If you are installing RSLadder for use with a third-party container, you must purchase the RSLadder software from Rockwell Software. From the RSLadder 5 or RSLadder 500 CD-ROM, run D:\CONSOLE.Exe where D is the drive containing the CD-ROM.
3. Follow the on-screen instructions.
   - If you are installing RSLadder from the RSView32 Extensions CD-ROM for use with RSView32 or RSView32 Active Display System, the RSLadder installation program does not prompt for activation.
   - If you are installing RSLadder for use with third-party software other than RSView32, the RSLadder installation program prompts for activation. Insert the Master disk in the diskette drive, and then click Finish.
   - For details about activation, see the activation utilities Help file, COPYRPROT.HLP.
4. After installation is complete, shut down and restart your computer before running RSLadder.

*Chapter*

# 2 Getting started with RSLadder

## Welcome to RSLadder

RSLadder ™ ActiveX controls display ladder logic for Allen-Bradley processors. Use RSLadder 500 with Allen-Bradley SLC 500 processors, and use RSLadder 5 with Allen-Bradley PLC-5 processors. RSLadder allows you to view ladder logic, both offline and online, inside RSView32, or inside other software applications that support ActiveX controls.




With RSLadder you can:

- configure properties and communications using tabbed property pages—no coding required!
- locate a specific ladder logic section by using page titles in your ladder project
- search for instructions, addresses, and symbols in your ladder logic program files
- monitor ladder logic directly from an Allen-Bradley SLC 500 or PLC-5, eliminating the need for ladder programming software
- customize your projects using RSLadder's object model. For example, create custom troubleshooting displays that change ladder files or jump to specific rungs in response to alarm conditions

# Using RSLadder with RSView32

To use RSLadder with RSView32, insert an RSLadder ActiveX control in an RSView32 graphic display and configure the control to use an existing ladder logic file. When you run the project, configure RSLadder to communicate with the appropriate processor.

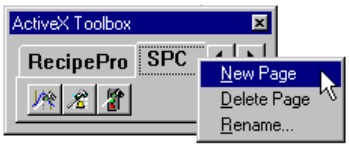
To run an RSView32 project, from the RSView32 Project Manager, click the Runtime tab, and then click the Run Mode button. Open the graphic display that includes the RSLadder control.

You can also use the RSLadder controls in other applications, such as Microsoft Visual Basic or an HTML page, that support ActiveX controls. The instructions in this guide refer to using RSLadder inside RSView32. If you are using a third-party application, refer to its documentation to determine equivalent procedures for ActiveX controls.

## Adding RSLadder to the ActiveX Toolbox

The RSView32 ActiveX Toolbox provides quick access to the ActiveX controls you use most often. To add an RSLadder button to the toolbox:

1. In RSView32 Edit Mode, create a new graphic display or open an existing display.
2. If the ActiveX Toolbox is not open on your screen, select ActiveX Toolbox from the View menu.
3. Right-click inside the tab area, near the top of the toolbox. Click New Page.




4. Right-click the New Page name and rename it RSLadder.
5. Right-click inside the new RSLadder page, and then click Additional Controls.
6. From the list of installed controls, select the Rockwell Software RSLadder control check box, and then click OK.

The ActiveX Toolbox supports up to 10 tabbed pages. Adding a tabbed page is optional—you can simply add controls to existing tabbed pages. The number of tabs you can view at one time depends on the length of the tab names. For information about adding new tabbed pages and tool tips, search the RSView32 online help using the keywords ActiveX Toolbox.

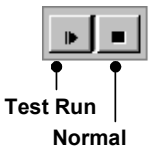
## Adding RSLadder to a graphic display

1. Start RSView32 and open a project. From the RSView32 Project Manager, create a new graphic display.
2. From the RSView32 menu, select Objects > ActiveX Control.
3. Click and drag on the graphic display to place the control.
4. Scroll through the list of controls, select Rockwell Software RSLadder 500 or RSLadder 5, and click OK.

## Configuring RSLadder properties

The RSLadder ActiveX controls offer quick access to their properties. To configure RSLadder properties inside RSView32:

1. In RSView32, open a graphic display that contains the embedded RSLadder ActiveX control.
2. To configure RSLadder properties, do one of the following:
   - right-click the RSLadder control. From the menu, select RSLadder Object > Properties
   - click the RSLadder control to select it; from the RSView32 menu, select View > ActiveX Property Panel




3. To check the results of your changes, click the Test Run button on the RSView32 toolbar.

## Loading a ladder file in RSLadder

1. Open the RSLadder Properties dialog.

   Right-click the RSLadder control. From the menu, select RSLadder Object > Properties.
2. On the General tab, in the File Name box specify the path and filename of the ladder project you want to load. Look for the appropriate file extension: .ACH, .RSS, .LIB, .X5, or .RSP.
3. In the Prog File box, specify which file within the project you want to display.
4. Click OK to close the RSLadder properties.

## Configuring communications in RSLadder

Before you can go online with a processor, first configure a driver in RSLinx, and then tell RSLadder which communications driver to use and which node the processor is on.

1. Run the RSView32 project that contains the RSLadder control.
2. Right-click the RSLadder control. From the menu, select Config Comms.
3. Click Who Active to open RSLinx.
4. Select the appropriate network type and node.
5. Click OK to close the dialogs.

## Running an RSLadder project

All of the RSLadder runtime features are available from a convenient right-click menu. While running RSLadder, you can search through the displayed ladder file for symbols, addresses, descriptions, and instructions. For details, see page 17.

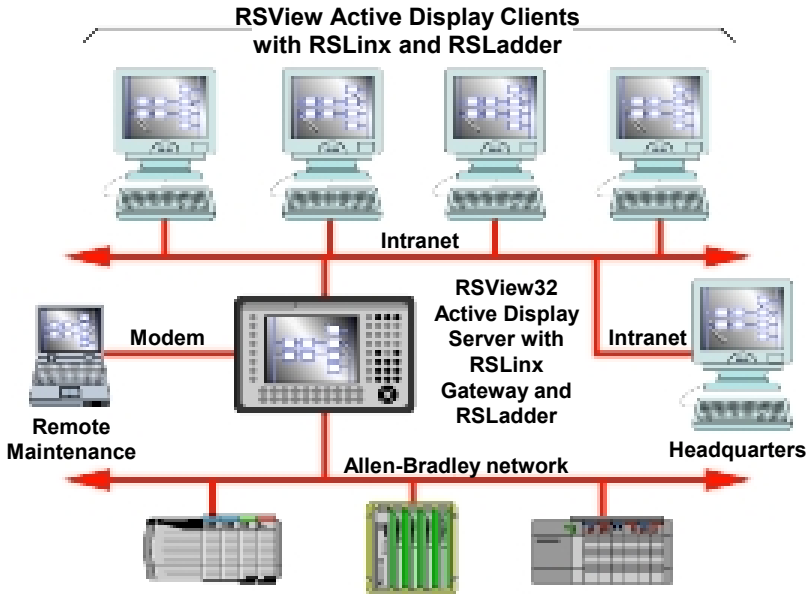
You can also interact with the processor to which RSLadder is communicating:

- **Go online with a processor**. Before going online with a processor, first configure communications between RSLadder and RSLinx. When you go online with or upload from a processor, that processor's project loads into RSLadder. If the processor is not running, select Go to Run Mode from the right-click menu.
- **Download to a processor**. When you select Download from the right-click menu, the ladder logic file currently loaded in the RSLadder control downloads to the processor.
- **Upload from a processor**. When you select Upload from the right-click menu, the ladder logic file currently loaded in the processor uploads to RSLadder. The location for saving the file defaults to the Upload Path specified in the RSLadder properties, however, you can specify a different directory.
- **Load from or store to EEPROM**. From the RSLadder runtime menu, you can transfer the current program in the processor's EEPROM to the processor's RAM. You can also store the program in processor memory to the processor's EEPROM module. To use these options, RSLadder must be online with the processor, and the processor must be in Program or Remote Program mode.
- **Change processor modes**. While online with a processor, you can switch between Program and Run modes.

**TIP** To prevent operators from interacting with the processor, you can disable individual options, or you can hide the runtime right-click menu in RSLadder. For details, see page 18.

# Using RSLadder with RSView32 Active Display System

When using RSLadder with RSView32 Active Display System, you need to first configure RSLinx Gateway to provide remote communications. RSLinx Gateway includes all the functionality of RSLinx Professional and adds remote client connectivity through TCP/IP. Remote client connectivity allows additional workstations running RSLinx or an OPC client application to "gateway" to Allen-Bradley networks connected to the server. In an RSView32 Active Display System, the gateway allows remote clients access to the Allen-Bradley networks connected to the server on the other side of the gateway.




## Configuring the Active Display Server

1. Configure RSLinx Gateway.

   For help, see Configure RSLinx Gateway on page 3.

2. Start RSView32 and open a project. From the RSView32 Project Manager, create a new graphic display.

3. Insert an RSLadder ActiveX control.

   For help, see Adding RSLadder to a graphic display on page 9.

4. Right-click the RSLadder control. From the menu, select RSLadder Object > Properties.
5. In the File Name box, browse for and select an existing ladder file (look for the appropriate file extension: .ACH, .RSS, .LIB, .X5, or .RSP). Make a note of the file location.
6. From the RSView32 Project Manager, open the System folder, and then open the User Accounts editor. Add a user account for each Active Display client.
7. Open the RSView32 Command Line and run the command **DisplayServerOn**.

## Configuring the Active Display clients

At each client, configure each driver that you want to be able to access through the RSLinx Gateway.

1. At each Active Display client station, open RSLinx and select Configure Drivers.
2. From the list of Available Driver Types, select Remote Devices via Linx or 1756-ENET Gateway. Click the Add New button.
3. Type a name for the driver.
4. From the list of available servers, select the RSLinx Gateway server.
5. From the list of available remote drivers associated with the selected server, select the driver for the network you want to access.
6. To cause logic files to open automatically on the client, place the files in the same path on both the client and on the server.
7. Configure a connection from the client to the Active Display Server.
   - For the initial graphic display, select the graphic display that contains the RSLadder object that you created on the server (see step 2 on page 11).
   - For the user account, select the account that you created on the server (see step 6 on page 12).

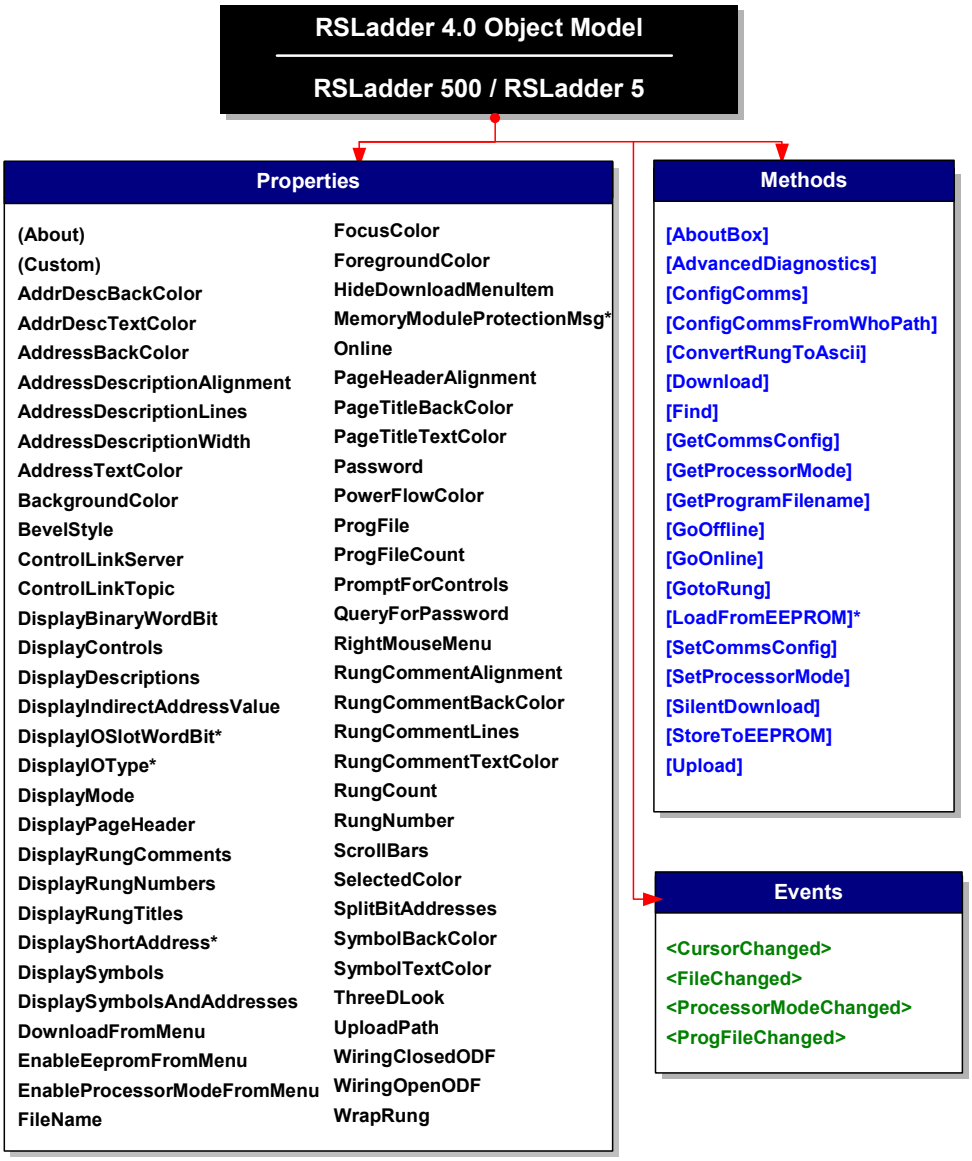
## Going online with a processor from a client

1. At an Active Display client station, run RSView32 and open the graphic display that contains the RSLadder control.
2. Right-click the RSLadder control and select Config Comms.
3. Click WhoActive.
4. Select the driver you configured on the client.
5. Select the processor you want to access.
6. Click OK twice to close all open dialogs.

   The graphic display should now show RSLadder online with the processor. You can use properties and methods from the client, just as you can from the Active Display Server.

# Automating RSLadder functions with its object model

The RSLadder controls expose object models that provide programming access through Microsoft Visual Basic for Applications™, a programming language embedded in RSView32. For details, see the RSLadder online help.




** applies only to RSLadder 500 control*

# Quick Start steps

The following steps guide you through configuring and exploring an RSLadder control in RSView32. This quick start example uses a sample ladder logic file that installs with RSLadder.

Before you begin, follow the instructions in Chapter 1 to:

- install RSView32 and RSLinx, if necessary
- install RSLadder on a computer where RSView32 is installed

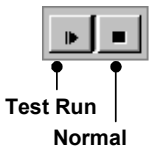
## Step 1 ▪ Configure an RSLadder control

1. Start RSView32 and create a new project.
2. From the RSView32 Project Manager, create a new graphic display.
3. Insert either the RSLadder 500 or RSLadder 5 ActiveX control.

   Use the ActiveX Toolbox, or from the RSView32 menu, select Objects > ActiveX Control.
4. Right-click the control and select Rockwell Software RSLadder object > Properties.
5. On the General tab, click the Browse button to the right of the File Name box. Locate and open an existing ladder logic file.

   For these quick start steps, open Demo.rss if you are using RSLadder 500, or open Demo.rsp if you are using RSLadder 5. The default location for these RSLadder sample files is: c:\Program Files\Rockwell Software\RSLadder 500 (or RSLadder 5)\Samples\Demo.rss (or Demo.rsp).
6. Explore the other tabs without changing any of the default settings. Click OK.
7. To add a border to the control so that you can see its boundaries more easily, click the control to select it. From the RSView32 menu, select View > ActiveX Property Panel.
8. Change the BevelStyle property to Indented. Close the ActiveX Property Panel.
9. Save the display with the name RSLadder, and leave the display open on your screen.

## Step 2 ▪ Explore ladder logic views



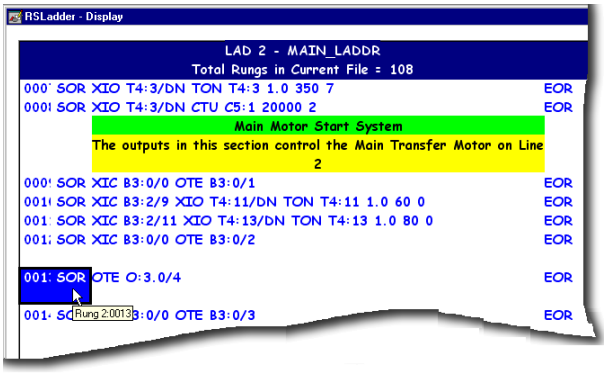

1. Test run the RSLadder display that you just created.

   On the RSView32 Toolbar, click the Test Run button.

2. Right-click the RSLadder control and select Properties.

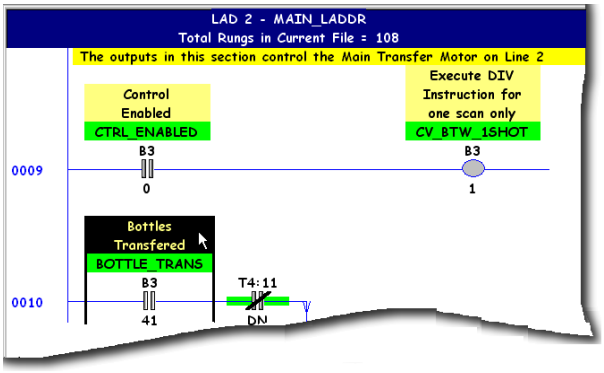
3. On the General tab, change the Display Mode to ASCII. Click OK.

   Use the mouse, arrow keys, and scroll bars to explore the ladder file.




4. Right-click the control again and select Properties. On the General tab, change the Display Mode to Ladder. Click OK.

   Use the mouse, arrow keys, and scroll bars to explore the ladder file.

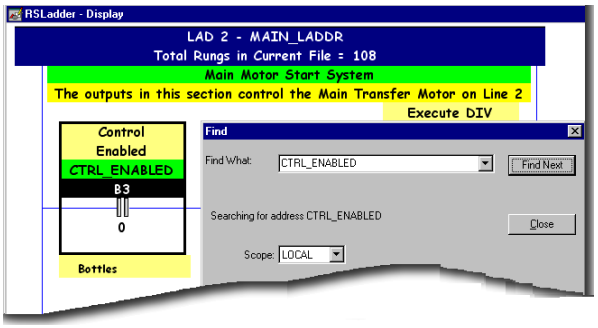



RSLadder also offers Wiring mode. Wiring mode displays the ladder logic with wiring diagrams in place of any I/O instructions that have device codes assigned to them. RSLadder includes several sample wiring diagrams in .ODF format. For more information about Display Modes, click the Help button on the General tab.

## Step 3 ▪ Find instructions, addresses, and symbols

1. With your RSLadder control display configured for Ladder mode, and with Test Run still active in RSView32, right-click the control and select Find.

2. Search through the ladder file using the samples below. When you finish searching, click the Close button.
   - **Symbol search**. CTRL_ENABLED
   - **Address search**. B3:0
   - **Description search**. Toggle Switch
   - **Instruction search**: TON

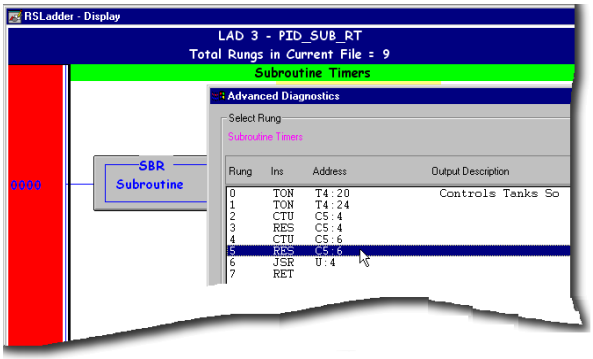



3. Right-click the RSLadder control again, and then select Advanced Diagnostics.

4. Select program file 2, and then click the Expand button.

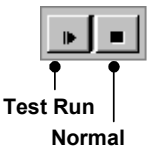
   The ladder display jumps to the appropriate place in the ladder file. The Advanced Diagnostics box lists the page titles associated with program file 2.

5. Select a page title, and then click Expand again to display a list of output instructions in that section. When you finish exploring, click the Close button.

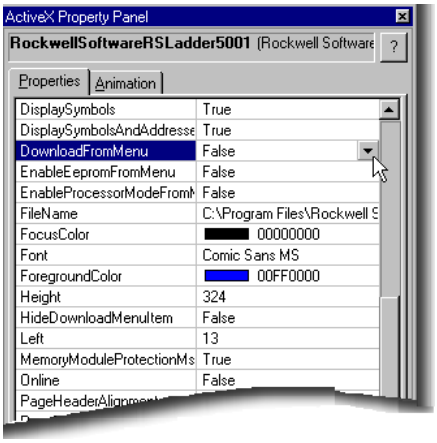


## Step 4 ▪ Configure runtime menu options

You can configure the options available to operators from the right-click menu during runtime. If you choose to, you can enable or disable individual options, or you can hide the right-click menu during runtime.




1. With the RSLadder display you created earlier still open on your screen, stop Test Run mode and return to Normal mode.
2. Click the RSLadder control to select it.
3. From the View menu, select ActiveX Property Panel.




4. Explore the options that you can enable and disable on the runtime menu:
   - DownloadFromMenu
   - EnableEepromFromMenu
   - EnableProcessorModeFromMenu
   - HideDownloadMenuItem

   To see the effects of enabling and disabling these options, change the settings and then close ActiveX Property Panel. Test Run the RSLadder display and right-click the RSLadder control to open the runtime menu.
5. To completely hide the menu during runtime, open the ActiveX Property Panel and set RightMouseMenu to False.

   For more information about the runtime menu and RSLadder properties, see the RSLadder online help.

*Chapter*

# 3 Getting the information you need

## Using RSLadder online help

RSLadder online help provides overviews, reference information, and step-by-step procedures for working with all of the features in RSLadder. To open the RSLadder online help, search for and open the RSLadder.hlp file or while running RSLadder, click the Help button on any tabbed property page.

### Viewing and printing the help contents

For an overview of the RSLadder help, click the Contents tab, and then double-click the RSLadder book. To print a group of help topics, select a book from the Contents tab, and then click the Print button. All of the individual topics in that book will print.

### Printing a popup help topic

To print a topic in a popup window, right-click it, and then select Print Topic from the context menu.

### Learning more about using online help

To learn tips and tricks for getting the most out of the help system, on the RSView32 menu bar, click Help > Using Help.

### Finding RSLadder version information

To check the version number of an RSLadder control, run the project and right-click the control. From the runtime menu, select About.

# For more information

For information about RSView32 and RSView32 Active Display System, refer to the following publications. These books are available on the product CD-ROMs.

**RSView32 Getting Results Guide**
Rockwell Software
Publication ID: 9399-2SE32GR

**RSView32 User's Guides**
Rockwell Software
Publication ID: 9399-2SE32UG

**RSView32 Active Display System Getting Results Guide**
Rockwell Software
Publication ID: 9399-RSVADSGR

## Technical support

If you have questions about RSView32, RSView32 Active Display System, or RSLinx, consult the user's guides or the help. For questions about RSLadder, consult this Getting Results Guide or the online help. If you can't find the answer, contact Rockwell Software Technical Support:

Telephone—**440-646-7800**

Fax—**440-646-7801**

World Wide Web—**www.software.rockwell.com/support**

Support staff are available Monday to Friday 8 AM to 5 PM Eastern Standard Time, except during U.S. holidays.

### When you call

When you call, you should be at a computer and should be prepared to give the following information:

- product version numbers
- hardware you are using
- Microsoft Windows operating system and service pack you are using
- exact wording of any messages that appeared on the screen
- description of what happened and what you were doing when the problem occurred
- description of how you tried to solve the problem

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